

Church Growth by Prayer Case Study

Pastor Pavel Goia

Spiritual Growth leading to health
in all areas of church life, as well
as to numerical growth

Context/background

- Church

no growth (plateaued)
division, conflicts, low involvement
(10-20% involved)
low attendance (90-120)
pessimistic/skeptical to
evangelism/growth/Bible studies

Context/background

- Community
affluent, educated
strong protestant grip/influence

Process

1. Prayer – developing a culture of prayer

- for them
- with them
- they praying
- praying for the community
- church becoming a praying church
- visiting and phone calling to pray

The whole process immersed in prayer

Process

2. Preaching (plus visiting)

- Systematic series on specific subjects, like prayer, spiritual growth, surrender, mission, involvement (using their gifts), love for God and love for people
- Stories sharing / interviews (short, relevant)

Process

3. Visioning

- Praying for God's plan/strategy,
- Praying for the Holy Spirit
- Leaders (and members) to pray for God's vision periodically

Process

1. Prayer
2. Preaching
3. Visioning
 4. Bible studies
 5. Community involvement
 6. Felt-needs seminars
 7. Evangelism campaign
 8. Follow-up
9. Analyze, improve
10. Repeat process

Process

5. Community Involvement – the church to become known and trusted

- A variety of events
- Consistent and relevant

Process

6. Felt-needs Seminars (plus survey for seminars desired)

- periodical and consistent
- building relationships
- getting them used with the members and the church
(local church building and facilities)

Process

7. Evangelism

- prayer (before, during, and after evangelism)
- row-hosts
- well organized in every detail
- small meals – develop interaction
- using visitors for some jobs, like ushers
(visitors vs members 50/50%)

Process

8. Follow-up

- pastor's class
- visits and phone-calls
- preaching on mission and gift discovery (seminars)
- having new members involved in church activities/work
- new members involved in Evangelism and Bible studies

Results

- church growth and attendance improved
(from an average of 90-120 to an average of 280-340)
- all ages represented
- baptism (growing every year - 9, 16, 23, 38, 51,
then average 50/year)
- 80-85% retention rate
- visitors – average 30-40 a week: new people,
former SDAs coming back, SDAs from other churches

Results

- Sabbath School – growth up to 16 classes
 - all ages strongly represented
- involvement in church activities - average 80% church members involved – 200-250 people working
- average 200-250 Bible studies/year
- no conflicts, no division – unity
- praying church, friendly church

Results

- activities during the week – serving church and community in a variety of ways
- surveys
- planted a new church, mentored a small group
- used mostly local people for seminars

Results

- momentum, faith, desire to help, joy,
feeling of success, positive environment
- 4 hours/week – local cable TV reaching the community
(about 110,000 households)
- local radio tower – 24/7 program in 2 languages

Results

- one of healthiest, fastest growing churches in the US
- tithe growth (people joyfully supporting the church)
- internet – 400,000 hits, visits, and downloads/month from over 70 countries
- local church - impact to global scale
- NCD – church went from 32% to 70% - among 15% of top churches